



MIDTERM REVIEWER

PE22 – PATH FIT IV (World Dances)

Topic: Origin of Dance & Historical Development

I. Origin of Dance

The word “dance” came from the old German word “danson”

➤ Meaning: to stretch

Dance is made up of:

➤ Stretching and relaxing

Dance is considered:

➤ One of the oldest forms of art

Early humans danced to:

➤ Express emotions (joy, fear, etc.)

Influences of early dance:

➤ Rhythm of the universe

➤ Rhythm of life

➤ Heartbeat (body rhythm)

Dance is a:

➤ Form of expression

➤ Natural human movement



II. Early Forms of Dance

1. Magic Dance

Purpose:

➤ To ask something to happen

➤ To overcome problems

2. Ritual Dance

Purpose:

➤ To appease spirits

➤ To gain blessings

3. Round Dance

Concept:

➤ Dancing around a central object

Belief:

➤ Power can transfer through movement

4. Imitative Dance

Purpose:

➤ To imitate actions

➤ Copy what spirits or nature should do



Reminder:

All early dances are connected to beliefs, culture, and survival



III. Historical Development of Dance

Dance is as old as:

➤ The first man

Early rhythm sources:

➤ Feet stamping

➤ Clapping hands

Dance is mentioned in:

➤ Bible (Old and New Testament)



Plato's Classification of Dance
Military Dance – for training and war

Domestic Dance – for social/life events

Mediatorial Dance – for religious/spiritual purpose



20th Century Dance

Dance became:

- A natural expression
 - Movement in harmony with music
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IV. Cultural & Organized Dance

EG Egypt

Origin of organized dancing

Seen in:

- Paintings and carvings
-

Greece

Dance used as:

- Exercise for body and mind
- Contribution:
- Inspired the birth of ballet
-

IN Hindu Dance

Considered:

- Oldest dance tradition

Unique feature:

- Every body part has movement
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V. Dance and Culture

Dance reflects:

- Cultural identity

Modern dance performances combine:

- Traditional + Modern styles

Dance promotes:

- Teamwork
 - Respect
 - Creativity
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STUDY TIPS

✓ Focus on definitions (Magic, Ritual, Round, Imitative)

✓ Remember Plato's 3 classifications

✓ Understand why people danced before vs now

✓ Associate countries with contributions:

Egypt → Organized dance

Greece → Ballet inspiration

India → Oldest tradition

QUICK REVIEW (FAST RECALL)

Danson = Stretch

Oldest art = Dance

Early purpose = Expression + Survival

4 Early Dances = Magic, Ritual, Round, Imitative

Plato = 3 types

Egypt = Organized dance

Greece = Ballet

Hindu = Full body movement